

1. Scripting Standards:

- Create always directory with name "scripts"
- Give a file name as a function name ex: "helloworld" and don't give test xyz etc if you want to print Hello world!
- Script should end with .shell (if multiple scripts are used)

2. Linux File Permissions:

- By default, Linux won't apply executable permissions to file. You need to make sure to have permissions.

Command: `chmod 755 helloworld` or (`chmod a+x` or `chmod u+rx` or `chmod g-x helloworld` etc.)

```
[akhan@CentOS 7 Scripts]$ ls -ltr
total 8
-rw-r--r--. 1 akhan akhan 48 Jun 27 12:03 myscript.sh
-rwxr--r--. 1 akhan akhan 22 Jun 27 12:36 helloworld
[akhan@CentOS 7 Scripts]$ chmod 755 myscript.sh
[akhan@CentOS 7 Scripts]$ ls -ltr
total 8
-rwxr-xr-x. 1 akhan akhan 48 Jun 27 12:03 myscript.sh
-rwxr--r--. 1 akhan akhan 22 Jun 27 12:36 helloworld
[akhan@CentOS 7 Scripts]$ chmod g-x myscript.sh
[akhan@CentOS 7 Scripts]$ ls -ltr
total 8
-rwxr--r-x. 1 akhan akhan 48 Jun 27 12:03 myscript.sh
-rwxr--r--. 1 akhan akhan 22 Jun 27 12:36 helloworld
[akhan@CentOS 7 Scripts]$
```

2. Script Format:

Good Scripting format makes code readable and easy to understand.

1. Define shebang: `#!/bin/bash` or `#!/usr/bin/env bash` (Universal for all shells)

- Definition: The very first line of a Linux/Unix script that tells the kernel which interpreter to use to execute the file.
- Syntax: `#!` (Hash + Bang).
- How it works: When you execute a script, the OS reads the shebang line, loads the specified program, and passes the script to it.
- Example: `#!/bin/bash` tells the system to use the Bash shell to run the script.

Why use `#!/usr/bin/env`? – It locates the bash executable file

- Hardcoded paths fail: `#!/bin/bash` will fail if a system has Bash installed in `/usr/bin/bash` or `/usr/local/bin/bash`.
- Dynamic Search: `env` searches the user's `$PATH` variable and automatically finds the correct, absolute location of the interpreter on that specific machine.

2. Comments (#)

3. Define Variables (Ex `name=Ameer`)

4. Commands (`echo cp, mv, grep` etc.)

5. Statements (`if, for, while`)

6. Make sure to give proper indentations for code readability

Best Practise:

Writing a clean, well-formatted shell script saves you hours of debugging and makes your life (and your teammates' lives) much easier.

Here are the ultimate blueprint and best practices for formatting a Bash script.

1. The Standard Script Template

A professionally formatted script should generally follow this structural flow

```
Bash

#!/usr/bin/env bash

# =====
# Script Name: backup_data.sh
# Description: Syncs local production data to secure cloud storage.
# Author:      Your Name
# Date:        2026-06-27
# =====

# --- 1. SETTINGS & SAFETY ---
set -euo pipefail
IFS=$'\n\t'

# --- 2. CONSTANTS & ENVIRONMENT ---
readonly BACKUP_DIR="/var/log/app"
readonly DESTINATION="s3://my-bucket/backups"

# --- 3. GLOBAL VARIABLES ---
LOG_FILE=""

# --- 4. HELPER FUNCTIONS ---
log_message() {
    local message="$1"
    echo "[$(date +%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S)] $message"
}

cleanup() {
    log_message "Cleaning up temporary files..."
    # Cleanup logic here
}
trap cleanup EXIT

# --- 5. MAIN LOGIC ---
main() {
    log_message "Starting backup process..."
    # Your core code goes here
}

# Invoke main function
main "$@"
```

2. Formatting Best Practices

Use the Right Shebang

Always use `#!/usr/bin/env bash` instead of `#!/bin/bash`. This ensures better portability across different Unix-like systems (like macOS and various Linux distributions), as `env` locates `bash` dynamically in the user's path.

The "Safety Header" (set -euo pipefail)

Include this right below your header. It prevents silent failures:

- set -e: Exit immediately if a command exits with a non-zero status.
- set -u: Treat unset variables as an error and exit immediately.
- set -o pipefail: Ensure that if any command in a pipeline fails, the whole pipeline returns a failure code.

Indentation and Line Length

- **Indent with Spaces:** Use **2 or 4 spaces** per indent level. Do not use hard tabs, as they render differently across different text editors and code review platforms.
- **Wrap Long Lines:** Keep lines under **80 characters** for readability. Use the backslash (\) to break long commands into multiple lines:

```
Bash

rsync -avz \
  --exclude '.git' \
  --exclude 'node_modules' \
  "$SOURCE_DIR" "$DESTINATION"
```

Variable Casing and Scoping

- **UPPERCASE** for constants and environment variables (e.g., readonly API_URL="https://...").
- **lowercase** for regular, temporary, and script-internal variables (e.g., file_count=0).
- **Always use local inside functions:** This prevents functions from accidentally overwriting global variables.

```
Bash

calculate_total() {
  local subtotal=$1 # Good practice
}
```

Always Quote Your Variables

To prevent word splitting and globbing issues (especially with paths that contain spaces), always wrap your variables in double quotes.

- **✗ Bad:** rm -rf \$target_dir (If \$target_dir is empty or has spaces, this can be catastrophic).
- **= Good:** rm -rf "\$target_dir"

Use Modern Syntax

- **Test conditions:** Use double brackets [[...]] instead of old single brackets [...]. Double brackets are safer, don't require quoting variables inside them, and support advanced regex matching.

- **Command Substitution:** Use `$(command)` instead of backticks ``command``. It supports nesting and is much easier to read.

3. Recommended Linting Tool

Before you run any script, run it through **ShellCheck**. It is a static analysis tool that will instantly point out formatting issues, syntax errors, and security vulnerabilities in your script. Most modern IDEs (like VS Code) have a ShellCheck extension that lints your code in real time.

3. Script Sequence:

Script always executes command in a sequential order like `command 1`, `command2` etc.

Example: `ls`, `pwd`, etc.